Prahlin Portfolio Work Log - November 5, 2026

Compiled summary for Thursday, November 5, 2026 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio after the November 4 Figma-derived Productivity Hacks formation; extracting and studying the complete pre-existing PDF worklog archive; refining the catcher's fold-triggered sunrays, triangle visibility, central depth, perspective mesh, and camera-aperture control; simplifying triangle content; updating Work Space hardware and Workflow inactive-panel sheen; permanently stabilizing landing-hero imagery and zoom-out behavior; renaming the Values section; rebuilding the hero-to-main-content transition around an EXPLORE threshold; aligning Featured Case Study metadata; and carrying the late-night visual system into the Cinerific and Alla Vostra project pages.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahlin Portfolio worklog format: compact opening summary, source-material review, baseline and goals, feature-grouped implementation details, committed-source sequence, validation, files and artifacts, follow-up notes, and output-artifact close. The record preserves the archive's dense technical voice, explicit repository evidence, dated footer treatment, and distinction between committed source work, local verification, documentation output, and deployment activity.

Coverage begins after portfolio_worklog_november4.pdf and documentation commit c3f0ea4. Six source commits were timestamped November 5 EST: ba29ebc, 7eec3aa, db9246b, d7ac180, d1c2a37, and f9769f2. The same late-night session concluded with project-page commit 21bc2b3 at 12:27 AM EST on November 6; it is included with its true timestamp rather than being falsely dated. At documentation time, HEAD, main, origin/main, and origin/HEAD resolve to 21bc2b391a2e31a2180f4a384de624cac5594a09. No Hostinger synchronization, GitHub Actions dispatch, public deployment, store submission, Figma-file mutation, or external communication was performed during this documentation pass.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Date and scope: used the requested November 5 title and the America/New_York timezone. Git evidence separates six November 5 commits from the 12:27 AM November 6 finalization commit while retaining the continuity of the late-night implementation session.
- Project reader: ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt with current source, assets, repository state, deployment notes, PDF inventory, and standing workflow instructions.
- Worklog archive: enumerated and extracted all 62 pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDFs with pdftotext, from portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf through portfolio_worklog_november4.pdf. Before this artifact, the archive contained 340 pages and approximately 180,614 extracted words.
- Archive comparison: reviewed every prior filename and section outline, then read the November 1-4 sequence in full and compared representative July, August, September, and October entries for title cadence, section order, bullet density, validation language, files-touched treatment, footer structure, and output-artifact closure.
- Nearest baseline: treated November 4 as the direct source baseline for the five-triangle catcher, fold interaction, Automation / Setup selector, organic lighting, hero reliability, Workflow hierarchy, and Work Space / Work Tools presentation.
- Repository evidence: reviewed commit messages, bodies, timestamps, statistics, changed-file lists, synchronized refs, the aggregate diff from c3f0ea4 through 21bc2b3, current source, and the reader-refreshed snapshot.
- PDF conventions: confirmed US Letter portrait at 612 x 792 points, white pages, compact Helvetica-family black text, bold section headings, unpadded lowercase-month filenames, repeated dated footers, right-aligned page numbers, and a recent November norm of four pages and roughly 3,000-3,500 words.

Baseline Status Before November 5

- Productivity Hacks already used five Figma-derived radial triangles with a shared center, exponential inward opacity, clickable hit regions, selected-top orientation, cootie-catcher folding, and an initial Automation / Setup selector.
- The organic center lighting existed as a static subordinate effect. It did not yet disappear at rest, travel outward with rotation, reverse inward during settling, or consistently remain beneath visible triangle surfaces.
- Triangle folds still compressed or dimmed too aggressively in parts of the cycle, making the formation appear only at the beginning and end while the ray layer dominated the middle.
- The catcher communicated inward opacity but needed stronger geometric depth: contact shadows, opposing highlights, center compression, and a perspective grid that could survive the animation without late appearance or hydration mismatch.
- The selector's center remained visually unresolved. Triangle cards still carried icons and empty image placeholders, and the Automation / Setup language lacked the final two-line typography, aperture mechanics, color wiring, and active-state hierarchy.
- The landing hero and Featured Case Studies remained functional, but zoom-out could create excessive vertical whitespace, hero devices could intermittently disappear after scroll restoration, and the green upper-page field did not clearly hand off into the darker main-content system.

Goals for November 5

- Make the sunrays invisible at rest, expand them from center to edge during rotation, and collapse them back inward before the catcher finishes settling.
- Keep triangle faces visible throughout folding, layer rays behind them, feather ray endpoints, and eliminate ring, square, or clipping artifacts.
- Increase center-directed depth without uglifying the fold animation or delaying decorative mesh visibility after settling.
- Finish the Automation / Office Setup control with an animated physical-camera metaphor, stable icons, project-tone color handoff, hollow inactive lettering, and responsive spacing.
- Update hardware and terminology, refine Workflow inactive panels, and stabilize hero layout and imagery without changing the accepted 100% composition.
- Establish a clear EXPLORE threshold between hero proof and the main landing content, then carry the page's navigation and color logic into dedicated project pages.

Work Completed - Fold Lighting and Triangle Visibility

- Changed the sunray system from a continuously visible decorative layer into rotation-only motion. Rays are absent while the catcher is static, expand outward from the shared center during the fold, reverse from the outer field toward the center as the selected position settles, and return to the hidden default state.
- Lengthened and smoothed the expansion / collapse curve, then repeatedly advanced the collapse endpoint so the ray cycle finishes with, and ultimately slightly before, the triangle formation. This removed the impression that light was still retracting after the paper object had stopped moving.
- Removed the circular completion artifact by eliminating the visible terminal ring and separating radial attenuation from the spoke geometry. The final frame no longer leaves a bright halo at the center.
- Feathered the outer edge of every spoke toward low or zero opacity. This conceals the rectangular bounds that became visible when rays reached maximum length without shortening the useful light field.
- Moved the complete ray layer beneath the triangle formation at all times. Rays become most noticeable when fold perspective exposes space between surfaces, producing an under-lighting effect instead of painting over the paper faces.
- Preserved triangle presence through the full animation by reducing excessive compression, tilt, dimming, and opacity loss. The formation no longer disappears simply because the spoke animation is active.
- Kept selection locking and reduced-motion behavior intact. The lighting adjustments changed presentation timing and depth order without weakening deterministic final orientation or accessibility.

Work Completed - Center Depth, Mesh, and Surface Modeling

- Explored three distinct depth strategies and retained the accepted combination: stronger center-directed surface modeling plus a perspective mesh, while removing the rejected intermediate treatment.
- Added direction-specific contact shadows along inward fold edges and opposing highlights on the facing surfaces. The paired treatment makes each triangle read as folded material rather than a flat gradient wedge.
- Introduced a five-color perspective mesh whose cells compress progressively toward the shared center. Each sector inherits the corresponding triangle family so the pattern reinforces the radial construction instead of appearing as a disconnected global grid.
- Kept the mesh subordinate to titles, number boxes, outlines, and surface gradients. Its density increases toward the center while outer regions remain comparatively quiet.
- Synchronized mesh visibility with catcher rotation: it hides during the inward fold, returns before the triangles finish settling, and is already present when the static formation becomes readable. This corrected the delayed pop-in seen after the initial implementation.
- Replaced runtime-varying SVG coordinate output with stable fixed-precision values. Server and client now emit identical mesh line attributes, eliminating the hydration warning caused by floating-point differences.
- Validated that the added mesh, shadows, and highlights did not introduce a slower visual fold. Decorative layers remain timed around the existing motion rather than extending its duration.

Work Completed - Aperture Control and Catcher Simplification

- Centered a large camera-aperture medallion over the Automation / Office Setup selector and allowed it to eclipse the parent toggle boundary. The circular frame now serves as the active-triangle color bridge and the control’s visual focal point.
- Built the aperture as animation-ready geometry rather than a static image. Shutter blades rotate and change their opening relationship during selection, evoking a physical camera mechanism instead of only scaling the center void.
- Mapped rotation direction to the clicked triangle: right-side selections keep clockwise camera motion, while left-side selections rotate counterclockwise. Removed the earlier stutter and avoided slowing the underlying catcher animation.
- Kept the wrench symbol for every Automation-associated triangle and the computer-gear symbol for Setup. State changes affect the medallion and symbol color, not the identity of the icon during animation.
- Rebuilt selector labels as two intentional lines: AUTO- / MATION on the left and OFFICE / SETUP on the right. Horizontally centered each label within the space between the aperture’s outer circle and its respective parent edge.
- Increased label size and line spacing through multiple passes. Active labels remain white; inactive labels use the landing UI / UX system’s pale green outside-only contour rather than a filled tint.
- Replaced CSS text stroke with an SVG morphology filter that dilates glyph alpha and subtracts the original fill. This produces a clean external outline without self-intersections in A, X, P, lowercase a, or other intricate counters.
- Animated project-tone background fill and border color with the selected state. Added reinforced black inner / outer framing and a thin dark outline around Alla Vostra’s active white label to separate it from the brighter orange surface.
- Removed all triangle icons from their internal boxes and replaced them with enlarged 01-05 numerals. Removed every empty image-placeholder box, leaving a cleaner numbered information hierarchy while preserving click regions and content mapping.

Work Completed - Workflow and Work Space Updates

- Replaced the previous workstation entry with the 2023 16-inch MacBook Pro using the Apple M3 Pro chip, 36 GB RAM, and 512 GB SSD. Omitted the marketplace-specific “Renewed” and “Space Black” qualifiers as requested.
- Replaced the prior WCV display entry with the UPERFECT 23.8-inch 120 Hz 1080p portable monitor, including HDMI and USB-C context. Removed the unnecessary “2x” quantity language.
- Raised color-specific sheen on inactive Workflow panels while leaving the black structural surface legible. The adjustment illuminates the designated panel color rather than brightening the already-visible dark base.
- Reduced the first increase slightly after visual review so inactive panels retain hierarchy and do not compete with the focused stage.

- Separated panel sheen controls from the star-gradient top zones. The correction affects the requested panel bodies only and preserves the accepted header-strip intensity.

Work Completed - Hero Reliability, Values, and Main-Content Threshold

- Diagnosed the landing hero's zoom-out whitespace as a hero-specific fixed-height / viewport relationship rather than a global section failure. Added ultra-wide and zoomed-out constraints that collapse excessive empty space while preserving the established 100% layout, behavior, and asset relationships.
- Prevented device-frame positioning from recalculating while the page was scrolled. This permanently addressed intermittent screenshot disappearance after scrolling down and returning to the top without repositioning the accepted device composition or introducing clipping.
- Renamed "My Core Beliefs" to "My Values" and "The Values I Represent" to "What I Represent" across the landing and About Developer contexts.
- Replaced the bright green Featured Case Studies underlay with the quieter blackish grid treatment used farther down the landing page. The cards now sit against a neutral field that better supports purple, orange, blue, yellow, and green accents.
- Added a centered EXPLORE capsule and subtle green delineation line between hero proof and main content. The marker creates an explicit start point without claiming that every following section is "selected work."
- Extended blackening into the lower proof stack to end the hero more decisively, then tuned the green-to-black field below EXPLORE through several timing passes.
- Preserved the accepted vertical gap from EXPLORE to Featured Case Studies while slowing the color fade. Green may reach the case-study eyebrow / heading area but returns to black before the cards begin.
- Increased the case-study introduction spacing enough to establish hierarchy without recreating the original excessive void.
- Left-aligned each colored PLATFORM label with its project title and horizontally centered DEVICE beneath that label, correcting the previous staggered metadata rhythm across the featured cards.

Work Completed - Dedicated Project Pages and Late-Night Continuity

- Applied the landing page's sticky, dynamically resizing navigation frame to both Cinerific and Alla Vostra. Added the same upper darkening / low-opacity guard so project content cannot become distractingly visible around the fixed navigation during vertical scroll.
- Mapped product identity into the UI Foundations / UX Product Flow toggle: saturated purple for Cinerific and screenshot-matched peach / orange for Alla Vostra. Active fills, borders, and shadows now follow the current project rather than the former uniform green.
- Kept inactive toggle labels completely hollow and transparent inside, using the exact pale green outer-contour language from the landing UI / UX and Productivity Hacks controls. The SVG outside-only filter avoids clipped inner strokes on a, X, and P.
- Brightened Alla Vostra's active orange from muddy red-brown toward the artwork's golden peach range and added a subtle 0.85 px blackish letter edge for white-on-orange separation.
- Added large PREVIOUS Case Study and NEXT Case Study controls across the top of each project hero. Arrows precede the left label and follow the right label, and desktop type / icon scale is approximately three times the replaced back link.
- Implemented circular order without inventing a missing route: Alla Vostra links left to Cinerific and right to the existing Credit King landing card; Cinerific links left to Credit King and right to Alla Vostra. Credit King can later receive a dedicated route without changing the ordering model.
- Protected hero copy and imagery by placing navigation in its own band. On phones, PREVIOUS / NEXT and Case Study use controlled two-line lanes, preventing overlap while retaining left / right directionality.
- Applied warm orange gradient numerals to Alla Vostra's four proof statistics and a magenta-to-purple gradient to Cinerific's "35 commits" proof value. Labels, cards, measurement behavior, and responsive structure remain unchanged.

Committed Source Sequence

- ba29ebc - Refined Productivity Hacks fold lighting and triangle visibility. Added rotation-only sunray expansion / collapse, feathered spoke edges, behind-triangle depth, artifact removal, preserved fold visibility, and refreshed snapshot context.
- 7eec3aa - Enhanced Productivity Hacks center depth and fold lighting. Added the five-color perspective mesh, contact shadows, opposing highlights, pre-settle restoration, and fixed-precision hydration stability.
- db9246b - Refined Productivity Hacks controls and catcher presentation. Added the animated aperture medallion, direction-aware shutters, two-line mode labels, hollow inactive type, triangle-number simplification, color synchronization, and responsive alignment.
- d7ac180 - Updated workspace hardware details and refined Workflow visibility. Replaced the laptop and monitor records, strengthened inactive-panel sheen, and separated panel lighting from star-gradient tops.
- d1c2a37 - Refined landing hero responsiveness and Values messaging. Stabilized hero frames, corrected zoom-out whitespace, and renamed the Values headings.
- f9769f2 - Refined the landing hero-to-case-study transition. Added EXPLORE, the delineation line, proof-stack darkening, near-black case grid, slower color handoff, added spacing, and metadata alignment.
- 21bc2b3 - Polished project navigation and branded case-study controls at 12:27 AM EST on November 6. Added sticky project nav, circular previous / next controls, project-specific toggle colors, clean hollow typography, brighter Alla Vostra orange, and project-tone proof gradients.
- The seven implementation commits changed the landing, Productivity Hacks, project switchers, dedicated project pages, About Developer copy, shared styles, and the generated snapshot. At documentation time all refs are synchronized at 21bc2b3.

Validation Summary

- Ran the standard project reader and reviewed the regenerated snapshot, source tree, Git state, deployment instructions, binary inventory, PDF archive, and standing Portfolio workflow rules.
- Extracted all 62 prior PDFs, totaling 340 pages and approximately 180,614 words, and compared their naming, structure, density, source-evidence language, validation treatment, and output closure.

- Repeatedly ran npx tsc --noEmit; TypeScript completed without errors after the mesh, selector, project navigation, and proof-gradient changes.
- Ran git diff --check during implementation passes. Application source remained whitespace-clean; the reader-generated snapshot is treated as generated documentation.
- Verified local HTTP 200 responses for the landing page, /projects/cinerific, and /projects/alla-vostra.
- Used headless Chrome captures and computed-style checks at desktop and 390 px widths to validate toggle contours, active gradients, sticky navigation, adjacent-case links, protected hero assets, mobile label lanes, proof-number paint width, and lack of horizontal overflow.
- Cleared only generated Next.js / Turbopack caches when stale styles caused source and preview to diverge, then restarted the local server and revalidated the final state.
- No GitHub Actions run, Hostinger sync, public deployment, store submission, external message, Figma write, or ancillary-repository modification occurred during worklog generation.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/ProductivityHacks.tsx - perspective mesh generation, aperture state, shutter direction, symbol mapping, simplified numbered triangle content, hydration-safe geometry, and retained selection behavior.
- app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx - hero-frame stability and landing transition support.
- app/page.tsx - workstation hardware, monitor data, Values naming, and retained landing-section integration.
- app/aboutdev/page.tsx - synchronized Values heading terminology.
- app/projects/{alla-vostra,cinerific}/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx - SVG outside-only inactive label filters and wrapped toggle labels.
- app/projects/{alla-vostra,cinerific}/page.tsx - shared sticky navigation frame, adjacent case-study controls, routing order, and protected hero placement.
- app/globals.css - sunray timing and masks; triangle visibility and depth; mesh, aperture, toggle, label, hero, Workflow, case transition, project navigation, responsive, and proof-gradient styling.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - reader-generated snapshot refreshed before PDF composition.

Follow-Up Notes

- Preserve the sunray layer below the triangles and keep its collapse complete no later than the catcher’s final settle. Extending ray motion past the fold reintroduces the detached-light effect.
- Keep the mesh coordinates deterministic and restore the mesh before the static formation becomes readable. Runtime-generated unrounded SVG values can recreate hydration mismatch.
- Use the outside-only SVG contour for hollow large type. Returning to CSS text stroke will recreate intersections inside a, X, P, and similarly complex glyphs.
- Do not replace the physical aperture with a static center-scale animation; blade rotation, direction handoff, stable symbol identity, and color-only icon changes are part of the accepted camera metaphor.
- Preserve the landing hero’s 100% composition when modifying ultra-wide or zoom-out constraints. The accepted fix is conditional and should not become a default-position rewrite.
- Keep EXPLORE as a general main-content threshold rather than “Selected Work.” Allow green to reach the case-study heading, but return to the near-black card field before the card surfaces begin.
- When Credit King receives a dedicated page, update both circular project links from /#credit-king to that route without changing left / right ordering.

Output Artifact

- Generated /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_november5.pdf using the established lowercase-month, unpadded-day naming convention. No Part suffix was needed because no earlier November 5 root-level Portfolio worklog existed.
- The title uses Thursday, November 5, 2026 as requested. The commit record explicitly identifies the one 12:27 AM EST November 6 finalization commit rather than obscuring the timestamp.
- The artifact uses US Letter portrait pages, black Helvetica-family text on white, compact technical bullets, repeated dated footers, right-aligned page numbers, and Codex document metadata.
- The synchronized source baseline is 21bc2b391a2e31a2180f4a384de624cac5594a09. The reader-generated snapshot and this PDF are the documentation outputs from this pass.
- No application source change, additional source commit, public deployment, external message, Figma mutation, or ancillary-repository update was performed during PDF generation.